



Northeast Collegiate Cyber Defense League

Info Session #1
Oct 02, 2026 ✨



Welcome

- Introductions
- NECCDL League Information
- NECCDC 2027
- Q&A

👉 Please hold questions until Q&A



Who?

- **President:** Joe Eastman (Champlain)
- **Vice President:** Andrew Aiken
- **Co-Secretary:** Damira Pon (UAlbany) & Matt Heath VanHorn (Embry-Riddle)
- **Lead Judge:** Matt Heath VanHorn (Embry-Riddle)
- **New Team Orientation:** David Murray (UBuffalo)
- **Co-Sponsorship Coord:** Joe Eastman (Champlain) & Damira Pon (UAlbany)
- **Social Media** Damira Pon (UAlbany)
- **Website:** Andrew Aiken



League Membership Fee

- Provides League Membership for one NECCDC season
 - \$75 for [exhibition teams](#)
 - \$100 for new teams
 - \$250 for returning teams



Exhibition Team Option

Low-commitment way to participate in the Qualifier round

- Access to Qualifier Beta and Qualifier competition
- **NOT ELIGIBLE** to advance to Regional or Nationals
- All team members must be active college students
- Only one exhibition team allowed per Northeast institution
- Any combination of undergrad and graduate students permitted



Exhibition Team Option

- Maximum of eight students per team
- Students **cannot** swap or overlap between exhibition and standard team
- Default Point-of-Contact is existing edu coach
 - If there is no regular team, then we work with edu Point-of-Contact
- No need for formal moderators



Coach Responsibilities for the League

- Serve as primary Point-of-Contact for League announcements
 - Relay relevant information to competitors promptly
 - Communicate any inquiries from competitors to the League
- Ensures completion of League membership sign-up & payment for membership fee
- Compiles & submits provided team roster data for regular teams



Coach Responsibilities for the League

- Represents your academic institution as a League delegate in votes
- Must be aware and knowledgeable of competition rules
- Coordinate local White Team Moderators for Qualifier and provide their contact information to League
- Serve as the emergency contact during competitions

NECCDC 2027

Overview





NECCDC 2027 | Team Leads

- White Team Co-Captains
 - Damira Pon
 - Mackenzie Marsocci
 - Jared Rudow
 - Matt Heath VanHorn
- Black Team Lead(s): 
- Red Team Co-Captains: Meredith Kasper & Dan Becker



NECCDC 2027 | Theme

Communications

Teams will have to maintain the privacy of communications while maintaining availability of systems.

More information about technology will be released later in the month via official channels.



Key Dates of the 2027 Season

- Roster Submission Open:
 - **Next Week**
 - ACHTUNG: Process is different ... it is a website
- **January 22, 2027:** NECCDC Roster Submission Deadline
- **January 30, 2027:** Qualifier Beta
- **February 06, 2027:** Qualifier



NECCDC Resources for League Members

- Team orientation
 - Focused on new team orientation for Qualifier prep
 - Conducted by UBuffalo Coach: **Dave Murray**
 - Offered to registered League members
 - Reach out to orientation@neccdl.org if interested



How to Support NECCDC

- Keep doing what you're doing & share with students/faculty from other colleges
- Recommend faculty, alumni or professionals (not coaching) for assistance with White Team remote grading of injects and/or in-person moderation
- Refer us to potential sponsors you may have contacts with - help us connect
- Have a special skill that you think would be useful? Let us know!
- White Team Volunteer Form at: <https://forms.gle/E1gKWPKyVMGLBPHK8>



Questions?